

ABSOLUTE BEGINNER'S GUIDE TO PYTHON PROGRAMMING

**MASTER CODING QUICKLY WITH HANDS-ON,
REAL-WORLD PROJECTS, STEP-BY-STEP GUIDANCE,
AND COMPREHENSIVE LEARNING FOR ALL AGES**

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BONUS APPENDIX: GITHUB PRIMER FOR DOWNLOADING SOURCE CODE

GitHub is a web-based platform used for version control and collaboration. It allows multiple people to work on projects at the same time. While GitHub hosts a vast array of projects and supports numerous advanced features, this primer focuses on how you can download source code from a repository (repo) without needing a GitHub account. A repository is like a project's folder that contains all of its files, including documentation, and stores each file's revision history.

Accessing and Downloading Code from GitHub

Step 1: Finding the Repository

- Throughout this book, you'll encounter links or QR codes directing you to specific GitHub repositories. Click on the link or scan the QR code with your smartphone to navigate to the GitHub page where the source code is hosted.

Step 2: Navigating the Repository

- Once you're on the repository page, you'll see a list of files and folders associated with the project. You might also see a description and additional information, such as recent updates, above the file list.

Step 3: Downloading the Source Code

- To download the entire repository:
 - Look for a green button labeled **Code** near the top of the page. Click on it to open a dropdown menu.
 - In the dropdown menu, find and click the **Download ZIP** option. This action will download the repository as a ZIP file to your computer.
 - Locate the ZIP file in your Downloads folder (or wherever you've set your browser to save downloads), and extract it using your operating system's file extraction utility. After extraction, you'll have access to all the files contained in the repository.

Tips for Using Downloaded Code

- **Exploring the Repository:** Once you've extracted the files, take some time to explore the folder structure. Repositories often include a `README.md` file, which contains important information about the project, including how to set it up and use it.
- **Requirements:** Some projects may require additional setup, such as installing dependencies. This information is typically found in the `README.md` file or a separate `INSTALLATION.md` file.
- **Seeking Help:** If you encounter any issues, check the repository's `ISSUES` tab for solutions or to ask questions. Though you'll need a GitHub account to post issues, browsing existing issues can be done without an account.

No GitHub Account Required

As outlined, downloading files from GitHub does not require a GitHub account. This makes it easy for anyone to access and use the source code for projects, even without being a part of the GitHub community.

We encourage you to explore the repositories linked throughout this book. Each repository offers a unique opportunity to learn from real-world code examples and apply what you've learned in a practical context.